

Sprint Planning Guide for PMs

Applicable Roles: PM, PO

Pre-Sprint Planning

3 days before sprint planning:

- Review current sprint progress
- Triage unfinished work
- Discuss with PO for next sprint priorities
- Prepare capacity report
- Update backlog with estimates

Sprint Planning Agenda

1. Review sprint goal (5 min)
2. PO presents priority stories (15 min)
3. Team discusses and estimates (45 min)
4. Assign stories to team members (15 min)
5. Confirm sprint goal and capacity (10 min)

Total: ~90 min for 2-week sprint

Capacity Planning

Calculate team capacity:

- Total developer days = team size x sprint days
- Subtract: PTO, ceremonies, support rotation
- Assume 70-80% utilization
- Buffer for unknowns (10-15%)

Velocity Tracking

Track velocity over 3-5 sprints to establish baseline:

- Sprint 1: 25 points (ramp-up)
- Sprint 2: 35 points
- Sprint 3: 40 points (stable velocity)

Use rolling average for planning

Risk Management

Identify and mitigate sprint risks:

- Technical complexity: Spike/prototype first
- Dependencies: Flag early, escalate
- Resource availability: Back-up plan
- Scope creep: Strict change control process